

Earth's Surface

This is your guided version. It uses shorter sentences, word banks, and fill-in-the-blank notes to help you learn one step at a time. Read slowly. Fill in every blank. You can do this!



Georgia Standard S6E5 • Supported Reading

WHAT YOU'LL LEARN

01 Inside the Earth

03 The Rock Cycle

05 Plate Tectonics

02 Minerals & Rocks

04 Weathering, Erosion & Deposition

06 Fossils & Soil

Name: _____

Period: _____

Date: _____

5.1 Inside the Earth

My Learning Goal

I can name Earth's four layers in order from outside to inside.

Earth is built in **layers**, like an apple. We live on the thin outside.

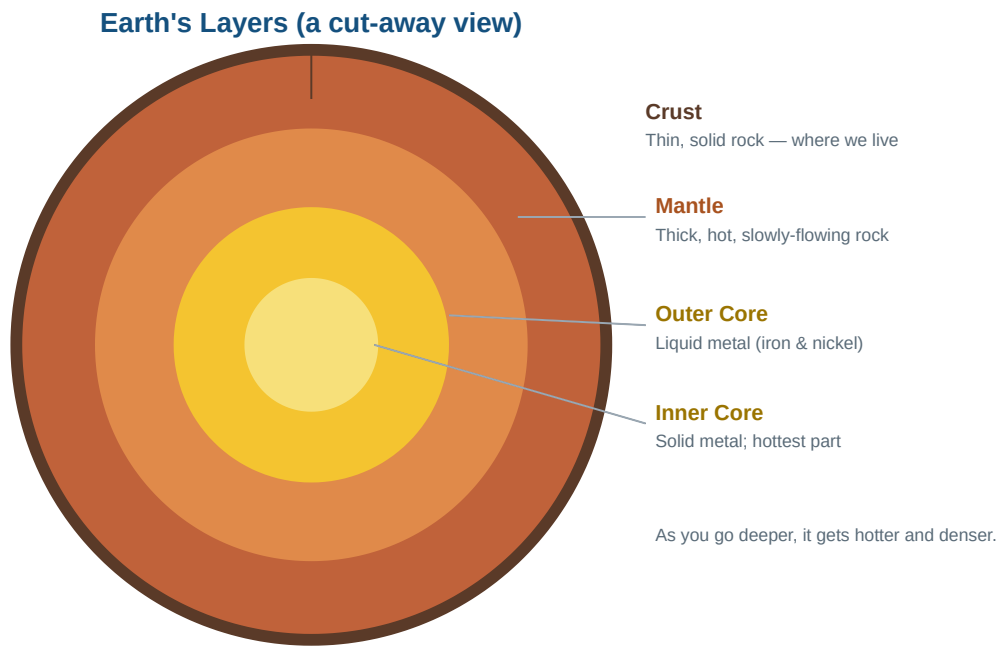


Figure 5.1 — Earth's four layers. Deeper means hotter and heavier.

Label the layers from outside (1) to inside (4) using the word bank:

Word Bank

Crust

Mantle

Outer Core

Inner Core

Order	Clue	Layer Name
1 (outside)	Thin rock where we live	_____
2	Thick hot rock that flows slowly	_____
3	Liquid metal	_____
4 (center)	Solid metal, hottest part	_____

★ Remember

The deeper you go, the **hotter** and **heavier** it gets.

5.2 Minerals & Rocks

🎯 My Learning Goal

I can tell the difference between a mineral and a rock.

A **mineral** is one pure ingredient (like quartz, gold, or salt).

A **rock** is made of one or more minerals mixed together.

★ Easy Way to Think About It

A mineral is one **ingredient**. A rock is the whole **recipe** (a mix of ingredients).

Circle the correct answer:

- A (mineral / rock) is one pure ingredient.
- A (mineral / rock) is a mix of minerals.

5.3 The Rock Cycle

🎯 My Learning Goal

I can name the three types of rock and how each forms.

Over a very long time, any rock can change into another rock. This is the **rock cycle**.

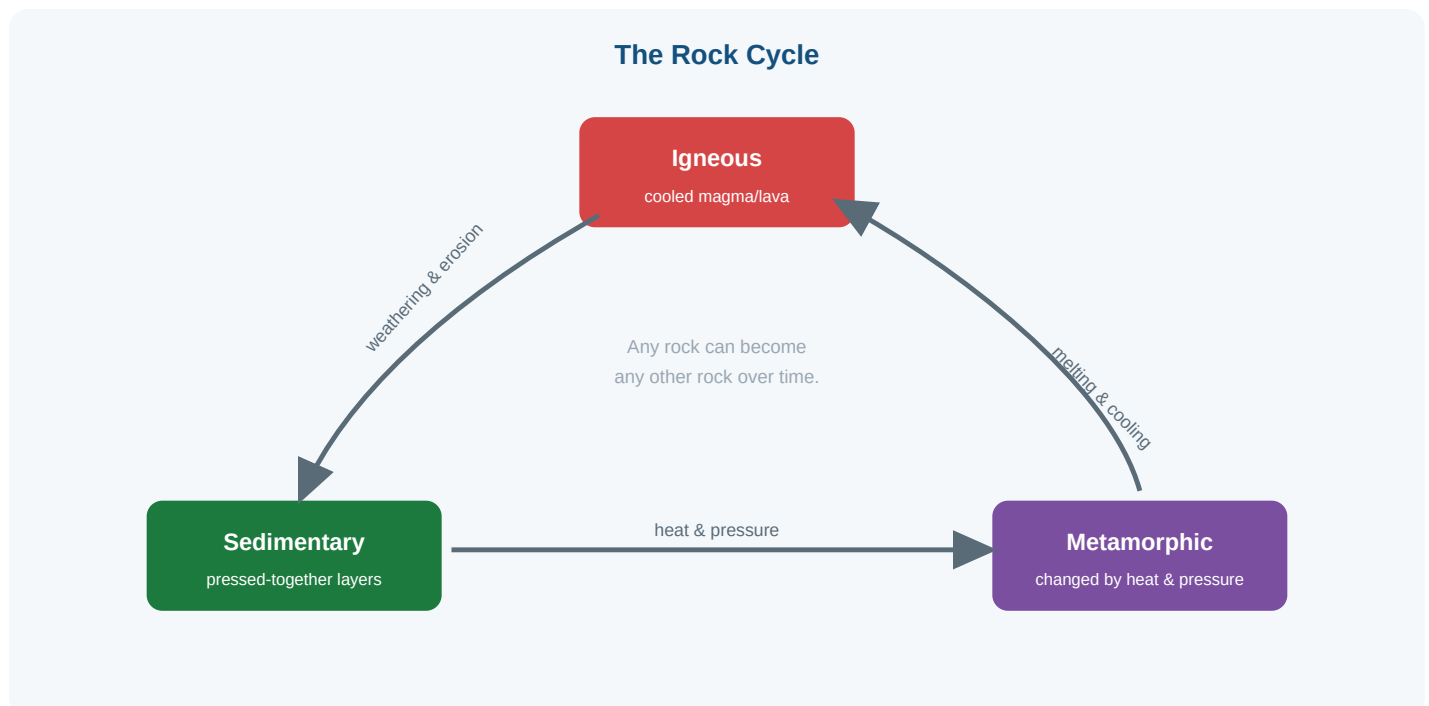


Figure 5.2 — The rock cycle. Any rock can slowly turn into another kind.

Match each rock type to how it forms. Write the letter:

Rock Type	How It Forms
Igneous ____	A. Layers of bits get pressed together
Sedimentary ____	B. Melted rock cools and hardens
Metamorphic ____	C. A rock is changed by heat and pressure

★ Name Hints

Igneous = fire (heat). **Sedimentary** = sediment (settling bits). **Metamorphic** = changed form.

5.4 Weathering, Erosion & Deposition

🎯 My Learning Goal

I can put weathering, erosion, and deposition in order.

These three steps reshape the land, in order:



Figure 5.3 — Weathering breaks rock; erosion moves it; deposition drops it.

- **Weathering** = rock breaks into smaller pieces (stays in place).
- **Erosion** = water, wind, or ice **moves** the pieces away.
- **Deposition** = the pieces are **dropped** in a new place.

! Easy Trick

Weathering = **w**ear down in place. **E**rosion = **e**xit (it moves away).

📝 Word Bank

weathering

erosion

deposition

Fill in the blanks in order (first, second, third):

- First, _____ breaks the rock.
- Second, _____ moves the pieces.
- Third, _____ drops them in a new place.

People also change the land by mining, building, and farming.

5.5 Plate Tectonics

My Learning Goal

I can explain how moving plates cause mountains and earthquakes.

Earth's crust is cracked into giant pieces called **tectonic plates**.

They float on the hot, slow-flowing mantle and move very slowly.

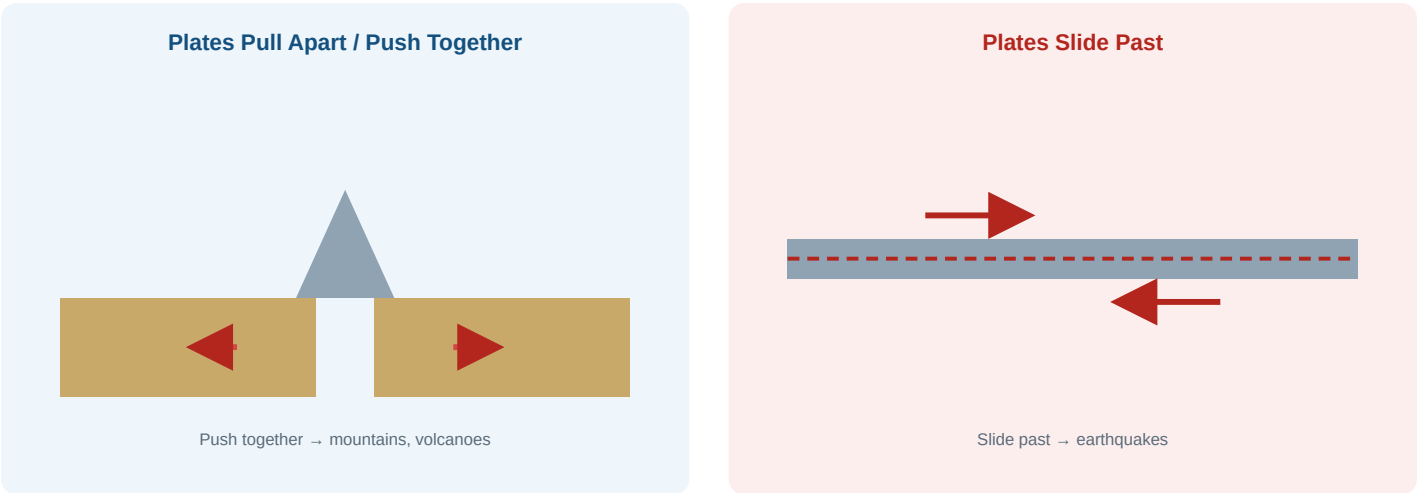


Figure 5.4 — Plates pushing together make mountains and volcanoes. Plates sliding past cause earthquakes.

Plates...	Cause...
Push together	_____ (Hint: mountains, volcanoes)
Slide past	_____ (Hint: shaking ground)

Fill in the blanks:

- An _____ is sudden shaking when plates slip past each other.
- A _____ is where magma reaches the surface.

5.6 Fossils & Soil

My Learning Goal

I can explain what fossils show and what soil is made of.

A **fossil** is the preserved remains of a living thing from long ago.

Fossils show that Earth's surface and climate have **changed**.

Example: sea shell fossils on a mountain show that land was once underwater!

Now let's look at **soil**. Soil is made of two main things:

- **Weathered rock** (tiny broken-up rock pieces)
- **Organic matter** (decayed plants and animals)

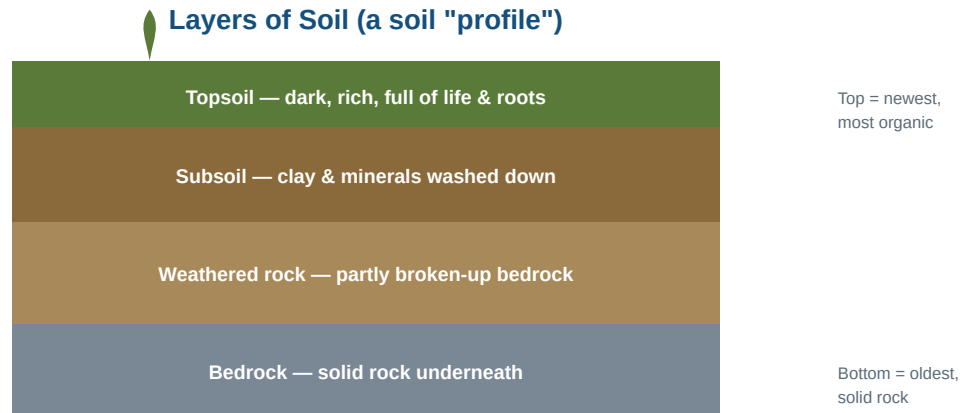


Figure 5.5 — Soil forms in layers. Rich topsoil is on top; solid bedrock is at the bottom.

Fill in the blanks:

- Sea fossils on a mountain show that the land has _____.
- Soil is made of weathered rock plus _____ matter.
- The top, richest layer for growing plants is called _____.

Chapter 5 Review

? Show What You Know

1. The thin layer we live on is the _____.
2. A _____ is one ingredient; a _____ is a mix of minerals.
3. The three rock types are igneous, _____, and metamorphic.
4. Order: _____ breaks rock, _____ moves it, _____ drops it.
5. When plates slide past each other, they cause an _____.